Gambit Gammon

A Backgammon & Poker Hybrid of Strategy, Luck, and Chaos

Objective

Win by bearing off all your checkers, as in standard Backgammon — but with the twist of poker-powered abilities earned through dice rolls, strategic card play, and doubles streaks.

Components

• 1 Standard Backgammon board

• 30 Checkers (15 per player)

• 2 Standard six-sided dice

• 1 Standard 52-card playing deck (no Jokers)

• 1 Discard pile area

• 2 “Doubles Streak” tracking dice (1 per player)

• (Optional) Doubling cube for scoring

Setup

• Set up the backgammon board as normal.

• Shuffle the deck and place it face-down within reach.

• Deal 5 cards to each player as their starting hand.

• Place each player’s “Doubles Streak” die at zero.

• Decide who plays first by each rolling one die — highest roll goes first.

Game Flow

Play follows standard Backgammon rules with these additions:

1. Card Acquisition — Gain cards by rolling doubles, capture swaps, 6-and-1 swaps, or streak bonuses. Max hand size is 7 cards.

2. Using Powers — Play a poker hand from your hand to activate its power. One power per turn. Discard played cards at end of turn.

3. No Countering — No counterplay to stop an opponent’s power once declared.

4. The River — Played cards refresh only after your turn ends.

Poker Hands & Powers

tion	Activation Conditions
ne die: Jack +1, Queen +2, King +3, Ace +4. Must be part of a continuous move.	Playable only with J, Q, K, A. Discar

tion	Activation Conditions
our two dice once this turn.	Declare before moving. Discarded a
cker in the opposite direction for one move.	Declare before moving any checker.
s in reverse using both dice for one turn.	Declare before moving.
e, or force opponent to reroll both.	Declare before moves are made.
cker immune to being hit for one move. Shield is lost if you stack your own checker on that point.	Declare before opponent rolls.
s of any two of your checkers on the board.	Declare before moving.
any value 1–6 for your current roll.	Declare before moving.
ice results this turn.	Declare before moving.
ull turn immediately after this one.	Declare at end of turn before oppone

Doubles Streak Powers

es Streak Level	Power	Type	Description
bles in a Row	Double Value Target	Permanent	Choose an opponent's checker; each time you hit it, draw an extra card.
bles in a Row	Omni-Move Piece	Permanent	One checker may move in any direction permanently.
bles in a Row	Mass Card Refresh	One-Off	Discard your hand, then draw 7 new cards.
bles in a Row	Invincible Piece	Permanent	Choose one checker; it cannot be hit for the rest of the game.
bles in a Row	Rampage Piece	Permanent	Choose one checker; hitting an opponent sends them to the bar and you draw 2

Card Acquisition Rules

	Rule Description	Notes
d	At the beginning of the game, each player is dealt 5 cards.	Ensures both players start with bas
and Size	A player can hold a maximum of 7 cards at any time.	Keeps hand sizes manageable and
n Full Hand	If you already have 7 cards and wish to draw another, you must discard a card first.	Prevents exceeding max hand size
ap	When you hit an opponent's checker, draw 1 card and they discard 1 random card.	Creates both reward and risk for att
ap	If you roll a 6 and a 1, you may discard 1 card and draw 2 new cards.	Provides a rare but potentially powe